

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – November 2021

Period analysed	March – November 2021
Months carrying comments	May 2021 – Nov 2021
Comments collected	368
Of which substantive	199 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	28 (14.1% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2021. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

368 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **199** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **28 (14.1%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

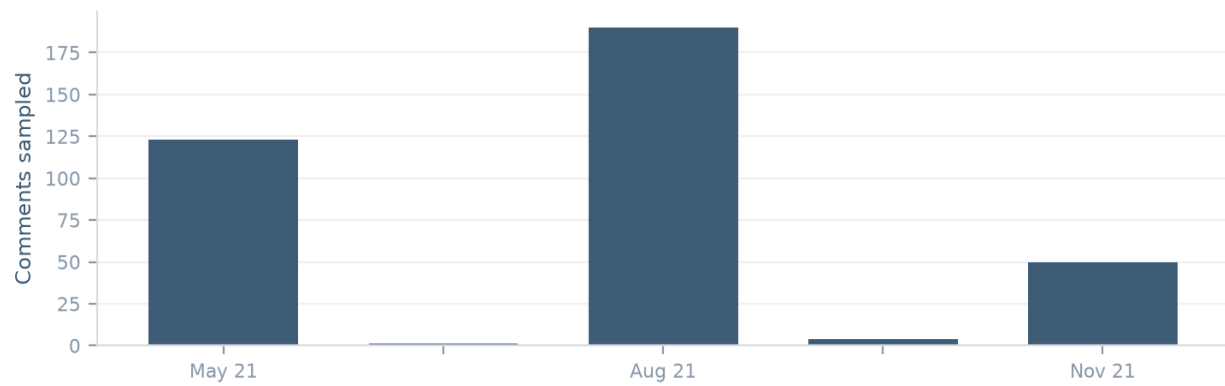
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

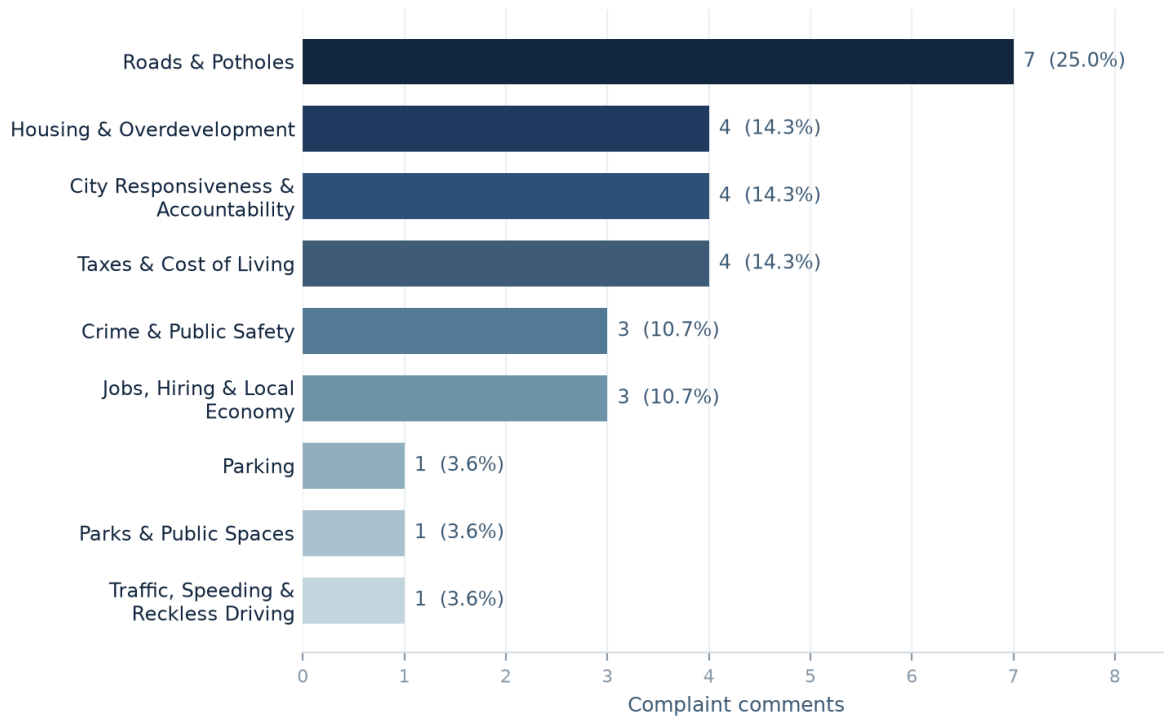
- Coverage for this window: 165 Facebook posts and 0 Instagram posts were sampled. Facebook's public feed is paged in date-bounded slices, so this is a sample of the period rather than every post the city published in it.
- This period is Facebook-only. The Instagram account's public feed could not be paged back past March 2023 - the crawl exhausted at 1,680 posts - so no Instagram comments exist for this window. Later periods draw on both platforms, which is worth remembering when comparing across reports.
- The city's pages drew far less engagement in this period than they do now - many posts carry no comments at all - so the complaint counts here are much smaller than in recent years. Compare shares between periods rather than raw counts.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts inside the window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it in this window. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 9 complaints

Roads & Potholes is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 25.0% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Roads & Potholes, Housing & Overdevelopment, City Responsiveness & Accountability — together make up 54% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

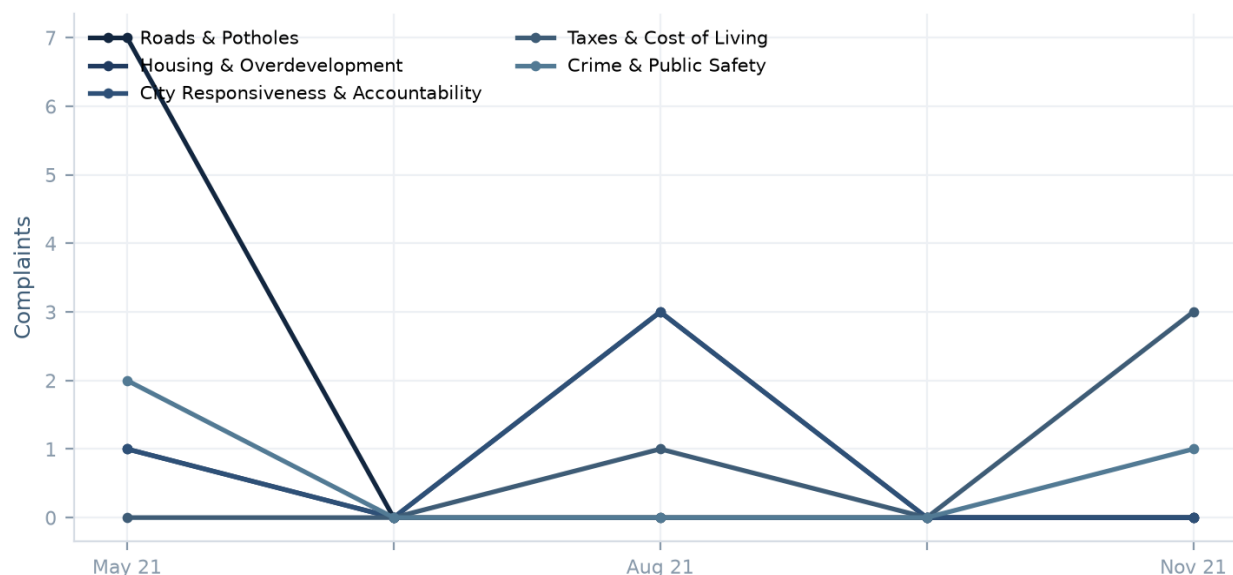


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Roads & Potholes	7	25.0%	2.0
2	Housing & Overdevelopment	4	14.3%	3.8
3	City Responsiveness & Accountability	4	14.3%	3.5
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	4	14.3%	2.0
5	Crime & Public Safety	3	10.7%	0.3
6	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	3	10.7%	0.0
7	Parking	1	3.6%	0.0
8	Parks & Public Spaces	1	3.6%	1.0
9	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	1	3.6%	0.0

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Roads & Potholes

7 complaints · 25.0% of all complaints · Facebook 7

"How was the winter harsh? Stop spending taxpayers \$\$\$\$\$\$ in other places and fix the ALL the roads. Patching a road isn't considered fixing it, you are just putting a band-aid on it to do less work. #uselesspoliticians"

Facebook · 2021 · 6 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

"Roads are horrible, now instead of a hole they are humps"

Facebook · 2021 · 5 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

"This is nothing new you have been using recycled tar that never last Spano, do we look stupid like you & Rubbo who think he doing us a favor. Fix them pot holes or fall into them!!!"

Facebook · 2021 · 2 likes · on: "****NEWS RELEASE***: CITY OF YONKERS ROLLS OUT RECYCLED ASPHALT TO PAVE ROADWAYS [Yonkers B..."

"How about fix the roads of pot holes first before asking people to rat out others?"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano reactivated the Graffiti Hotline and is encouraging residents to report a..."

2

Housing & Overdevelopment

4 complaints · 14.3% of all complaints · Facebook 4



"Really cuz my tenant applied 2 months ago and we still have not seen a penny of the 8 months they owe! I called the program and the person handling his application told me to be patient!! How much more patient can we be !???"

Facebook · 2021 · 2 likes · on: "****NEWS RELEASE***: CITY OF YONKERS AWARDS \$1.5 MILLION TO DATE IN EMERGENCY COVID-19 RENT..."

"How much housing is subsidized ? Taxpayers should be benefitting from their hard work!"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

3

City Responsiveness & Accountability

4 complaints · 14.3% of all complaints · Facebook 4



"Meanwhile the seniors are still in an unsafe building. Many have stopped going disgusted with all the empty promises and their ignored pleas. The promises made to them for a gazebo by July and a BBQ not fulfilled. We are entering fall. Where is the community in this picture? When will it be about the community? Sadly, it can not be until we have representatives that truly care about the people."

Facebook · 2021 · 12 likes · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

"I CALLED SEVERL TIMES ABOUT USELESS RUBBO DISTRICT THERE IS A SEWER CAVEING IN YOU FIND IT USELESS RUBBO USELESS RUBBO NEVER ANSWER HIS CALLS POS"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

"Something else for them to beat up and misuse just like those damn bikes!!!! What a waste of money!!! We need a new Mayor!!!!"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

"Only goes to show the mayor of Yonkers needs to be removed and impeached Covid only exist it's when they say for their personal needs you're putting our children in great danger with your nonsense yeah it sends and everybody out of business Meanwhile everybody else has to suffer we are Communist ways Meanwhile little businesses suffer from your wrath and your fake diseases"

Facebook · 2021 · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

4

Taxes & Cost of Living

4 complaints · 14.3% of all complaints · Facebook 4



"Great example that Yonkers is stuck on the times. Old and out dated.. The peoples tax funds have be going in the wrong hands. Not what it used to be,"

Facebook · 2021 · 2 likes · on: "■ Today is the 5 Year Anniversary| ■■■■■ Who remembers when Mayor Mike Spano and his staf..."

"I need a turkey■ where can I get one free I never get anything free that's so sad but I have to work for it oh well I'm here to pay taxes and die the only two things I have to do■■■"

Facebook · 2021 · 4 likes · on: "■ Mayor Mike Spano| Stew Leonard's ■ Turkey Brigade..."

"That's great! I've called the water department like 6 times trying to get an appointment for someone to fix our water meter. No one has called me back. Anyone else have this issue? Anyone's water meter not connecting and have you gotten a ridiculous estimated water bill?"

Facebook · 2021 · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

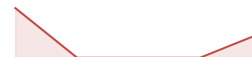
"only 32 units are affordable plain ridiculous and disgusting and by the looks of it there are more then 32 units"

Facebook · 2021 · 2 likes · on: "Affordable Rental Opportunity| 10 School Street, Yonkers, NY 10701 Applications may be p..."

5

Crime & Public Safety

3 complaints · 10.7% of all complaints · Facebook 3



"Police officer Patrick Creegan from 1st precinct is a disgrace to police officers. He is a pervert who exposes himself in public and has sex in his vehicle behind school yards and playgrounds. Sadly that's the bad apple of cops"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "Be A Hero Be the Change Take the Test ..."

"You should fix the crime rate in Westchester It is increasing by the day"

Facebook · 2021 · on: "The 2021 Westchester Power 100! Spot #4! Our Very Own Mayor Mike Spano Made the List! ..."

6

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

3 complaints · 10.7% of all complaints · Facebook 3



"Mike spano we need apartments in Yonkers jobs etc help us"

Facebook · 2021 · on: "Yonkers Arts Weekend (YAW)| Saturday, October 23 This year, YAW will showcase a wide range..."

"People gonna need more than rent assistance once they loose their jobs over not getting vaccinated."

Facebook · 2021 · on: "***NEWS RELEASE***: CITY OF YONKERS AWARDS \$1.5 MILLION TO DATE IN EMERGENCY COVID-19 RENT..."

"The City of Yonkers when will the application reopen? Your link says end of the month, which already happened. Not sure why Yonkers closed off applications on July 31st. NYS has their program open and many of your residents are in desperate need of assistance"

Facebook · 2021 · on: "***NEWS RELEASE***: CITY OF YONKERS AWARDS \$1.5 MILLION TO DATE IN EMERGENCY COVID-19 RENT..."

7

Parking

1 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints · Facebook 1

*"Ok what about the alternate side parking effects ?"*

Facebook · 2021 · on: "Message from Mayor Mike Spano..."

8

Parks & Public Spaces

1 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints · Facebook 1

*"Why don't they do this in SchultzPark that park needs an overhaul"*

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "➤■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

9

Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving

1 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints · Facebook 1

*"Some are riding on the sidewalks . None that I have seen so far ever stop at a sign or red lights . Must have forgot to read the rules ■"*

Facebook · 2021 · on: "Yonkers Police Department| ■ e-Bikes and e-Scooters - Rules To Know Before You Go..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Roads & Potholes	7	7	25.0%
2	Housing & Overdevelopment	4	4	14.3%
3	City Responsiveness & Accountability	4	4	14.3%
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	4	4	14.3%
5	Crime & Public Safety	3	3	10.7%
6	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	3	3	10.7%
7	Parking	1	1	3.6%
8	Parks & Public Spaces	1	3	3.6%
9	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	1	1	3.6%

“Primary” counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. “Mentions” counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.